SOE WEAPONS

A variety of ingenious weapons were available for SOE agents. Full-sized silenced pistols were common, and even crossbows were used, but many other weapons were designed by the SOE's laboratories in Welywn Garden City, near London, with the intention of concealment. Agents required weapons that were small enough to be hidden easily or disguised as everyday objects, from the relatively simple lapel knife and cigarette firing device to the more sophisticated belt pistol. Because these weapons were so small, they had a limited range – usually no more than 3.7m (12ft). Typically, though, this armoury of weapons would only be called into action if the agent's cover was blown and he needed to evade capture.

